



MBA FEES AT EDTECH FIRMS

EDTECH	MBA/EQUIVALENT COURSE FEE (in ₹ lakh)
UPGRAD	1.4
COURSERA	1.65
NULEARN	1.7
GREAT LEARNING	2
EMERITUS	1.7

SOURCE BT RESEARCH



FEES AT TOP 5 B-SCHOOLS

BUSINESS SCHOOL	MBA/PGDM COURSE FEE (in ₹ lakh)
IIM CALCUTTA	27
IIM LUCKNOW	21
S.P JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH	9.5-24
IIM KOZHIKODE	20
IIM INDORE	17

SOURCE SHIKSHA.COM

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such MBAs, but companies are seeing value in equipping their staff with more skills. Equally, individuals now have to decide if they want to invest more than a year to pursue an MBA, albeit remotely, or opt for shorter skill-based courses.

Vishwanath Pingali, Professor at IIM Ahmedabad, classifies online programmes in two categories: skills-based and perspectives-based courses. While the skills-based courses include training on artificial intelligence, cloud computing, analytics, etc., the management courses belong to the second category. “Though the current market trend is more inclined towards the skills-based training, there is still a strong demand for the management courses, especially executive courses,” he adds.

EMPLOYEE EVALUATION

A platform like Coursera, which has been ranked second among the edtech firms offering MBA in the BT-MDRA India's Best B-schools Survey 2024, provides an online or eMBA to the working professionals in collaboration with IIT Roorkee for ₹11.5 lakh. Coursera says the fee may go up to ₹20 lakh in the case of international institutions like the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (the US). In comparison, course fees for mainstream offline MBAs start at ₹16 lakh in newer IIMs like those at Bodh Gaya and Sirmour and may go up to ₹27 lakh for the top-rated IIMs.

If one looks past the course fee, though, recruiters are reluctant to view eMBAs on par with offline ones.

George Thomas, Group Chief Human Resources Officer at MSP Steel and Power, says online MBAs are good as long as they help in promotions or if they involve learning a skill set for a certain position. “We hire people with online MBAs only when he/she has certain years of experience or skills required for the position. Otherwise, during résumé evaluation, full-time MBA holders get more preference,” he says.

Thomas adds that companies prefer such courses since they help firms upskill existing employees and help them avoid hitting the markets in search of expensive recruits. It's only when an MBA is considered vital for a promotion that MSP encourages employees to take the course.

Echoing those views, the assistant vice president at a global commercial bank, who did not wish to be named, says edtech MBAs are ornamental for people sitting towards the top of the pyramid. It neither helps candidates change jobs nor adds value to the resume. According to a senior manager of a global telecom service provider, recruiters often subconsciously choose regular degrees over edtech ones. However, if the candidate possesses valid work experience that may take precedence in the assessment, the person says.

Besides, an eMBA may not be enough by itself to help people change their career path, something that is possible with an offline MBA. The senior manager says for senior positions, recruiters seek experienced candidates. “Pursuing an edtech MBA just for a career switch may not be effective.”